5.9 Meningitis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My neck is stiff and light hurts my eyes." **Objective** • Temperature 39.4 °C • Neck stiffness • Photophobia	**ACTUAL** Hyperthermia related to central nervous system infection as evidenced by fever and nuchal rigidity.	• Temperature below 38 °C within 24–48 hours.	• Give IV antibiotics without delay, as prescribed. • Give antipyretics. • Follow temperature and neurological status. • Isolate according to policy.	• Outcome reached once she is afebrile.
Subjective • Rates headache 8/10 **Objective** • Photophobia • Grimacing	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to meningeal irritation as evidenced by headache and photophobia.	• Pain at or below 3/10.	• Darken the room. • Give analgesia as prescribed. • Keep stimulation and visitors to a minimum. • Reassess pain regularly.	• Considered met when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Bacterial meningitis • Close contacts identified	**RISK** Risk for infection [transmission to others] as evidenced by risk factors: droplet transmission.	• No spread to contacts.	• Apply droplet precautions per policy. • Inform infection control. • Arrange prophylaxis for contacts as ordered.	• Goal reached if no secondary cases occur.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [37], [104], [117]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.